

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -
 ♥ K 6 3
 ♦ K J T 9 4 2
 ♣ T 9 6 2

♠ 8 5
 ♥ Q J T 9 7 4 2
 ♦ 5
 ♣ K J 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J T 7 4 3
 ♥ 5
 ♦ Q 3
 ♣ Q 7 5

♠ A 9 6 2
 ♥ A 8
 ♦ A 8 7 6
 ♣ A 4 3

West	North	East	South
	3♥	3♠	4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

You estimate your hand has 6 playing tricks. That is reasonable for a preemptive 3♥ bid. East overcalls 3♠ and partner bids 4♥. Everybody passes.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠K.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠K.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 3

This looks way too easy. If the ♥ finesse works and the ♣ finesse works you could make 6. It is when things look too easy that you should look for danger! What if you play the ♠A and West ruffs. What if West also gets a trick with the ♥K and East gets a trick with the ♣Q. What with your ♠ loser you would be down 1.

East probably has a 7-card suit to overcall at the 3-level, so if you play the ♠A West will ruff and one of your winners will disappear. So don't play the ♠A. Duck and let East win the trick while West shows out as expected. East will lead the ♠Q and you duck again. So East will lead the ♠J and you duck one more time, but now you can ruff in your hand.

Lead your ♥Q and finesse, West winning the ♥K. West will probably return a ♦ which you win in dummy. Play the ♥A. Then ruff a ♦ to get back to your hand and pull any trumps left out. Play a ♣ to dummy's ♣A and at long last play dummy's ♠A and discard your ♣ loser.

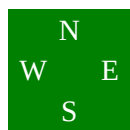
You always had 10 winners in this hand, as long as one of them didn't disappear.

To make sure the ♠A didn't disappear you had to hold it until West no longer had a trump.

Board 2
North Deals
None Vul

♠ J T 9 4
♥ 9 6 5
♦ J 8 5 4
♣ 9 4

♠ A Q
♥ A K
♦ A K Q T 2
♣ J T 7 6



♠ 6 5 2
♥ Q T 7 3
♦ 7
♣ A 8 5 3 2

♠ K 8 7 3
♥ J 8 4 2
♦ 9 6 3
♣ K Q

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♦
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by South
of them once the ♣A is gone. A 3-2 split in ♦s will assure 2 more ♦ tricks. There are lots of possibilities but you must be careful of entries and unblocking. In particular, you only have one entry to your hand (if you don't waste the ♠Q) and that is the ♣K Q. So you need to be sure to unblock the ♠A Q before you try to get to your hand in ♣s.

But there is something you **MUST** do first - test the ♦s. You win the ♠A and play ♦A, ♦K. East shows out on the second ♦! Now you unblock your ♠Q, then lead a ♣ to your ♣Q. Assume a defender takes the ♣A and plays a ♠. You win the ♠K, then the ♣K. Next a ♦ toward dummy, finessing West out of the ♦J. Dummy is now high.

What if you had carried out the plan up to the point when you led a ♣ toward your hand and the defense didn't take their ♣A?

You must abandon ♣s temporarily and take the ♦ finesse. You take your good ♦s and then go back to ♣s.

With 9 points opposite an opening 2♣ bid you are too strong for a negative response.

A suit response would promise a 5-card suit so you bid 2NT. Partner says 4♣.

Partner's jump to 4♣ over your 2NT is Gerber convention.

You have no Aces so you respond 4♦. Partner bids 6NT.

South to play 6NT. West leads the ♠J.

South to play 6NT. West leads the ♠J.

Winners: ♠ 3 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 0 : Total = 8

You need 4 more winners. The ♣ suit will provide 3

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6 5 2
♥ Q T 5
♦ Q 7 6 2
♣ 7 4 3

♠ A Q 8
♥ A 7 6 2
♦ 8 5 4
♣ A Q 9

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J T 9 4
♥ J 9 3
♦ T 9 3
♣ 8 5 2

♠ K 7 3
♥ K 8 4
♦ A K J
♣ K J T 6

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by North
few losers to worry about.

Partner has a balanced hand with 15-17 points. You have a balanced hand with 18 points. Together that makes two balanced hands with 33-35 points.

So you bid 6NT.

South would play 6NT.

Click

North plays 6NT. East leads the ♠J.

North plays 6NT. East leads the ♠J.

Winners: ♠ 3 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 4 : Total = 11

It's nice to make Plans for slams because there are so

This one is definitely straightforward. You need to get one more winner. You can hope for a 3-3 ♥ split which would mean your fourth ♥ would become a winner, or you can hope that East has the ♦Q in which case a simple finesse will give you the winner. But instead of making it an either/or situation you can combine your chances.

Win the first trick in either hand and duck a ♥. Win the return and play your 4 ♣ winners (discarding a ♦ from your hand) followed by your other 2 ♠ winners. Then play ♦A, ♥K and ♥A. You will be in your hand with two cards - the ♥7 and the ♦8. If the ♥7 is good, cash it and win the last trick with dummy's ♦K. If the ♥7 is not a winner then finesse the ♦J.

Always be on the lookout for situations where there are two possible routes to success.

Here the ♦ finesse was one possibility, but by ducking a ♥ you could test the ♥ suit and still keep the ♦ finesse in reserve.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 3 2

♥ A 8

♦ K Q J 3

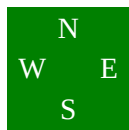
♣ 8 7 4 3

♠ Q J 5

♥ Q 9 6 2

♦ A 7 4

♣ Q J 6



♠ 8

♥ K 7 5 4

♦ T 8 6

♣ K T 9 5 2

♠ A K T 9 6 4

♥ J T 3

♦ 9 5 2

♣ A

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

3♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

Win the ♦ A and play the ♣ 6 to your ♣ A. Play ♠ A, then a small ♠ to dummy's ♠ J. Lead the ♣ Q. If East covers, ruff and re-enter dummy with a trump so you can discard a ♦ loser on the ♣ J. If East doesn't cover the ♣ Q when you lead it, discard a ♦ immediately. As long as East holds the ♣ K you can make the contract. This is called a Ruffing Finesse.

In some hands there is more than one way to make the contract.

But in this deal the ruffing finesse is the only Plan that works.

You open 1♠ and partner responds 2♥.

With only 14 points and a 6-card suit you rebid a minimum 2♠. Partner raises to 3♠.

Your bids show 13-15 points. Partner has decided to invite you to bid game with a maximum. Since you have 14 points it's not really clear whether you should accept the invitation. You decide to add a little for your singleton Ace and bid 4♠.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♦ K.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♦ K.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 4

The two fast losers in ♥s can't be helped, but maybe you can get rid of one of the ♦ losers.